

THE PATH TO HOUSING RECOVERY

NEPAL EARTHQUAKE 2015: HOUSING RECONSTRUCTION
THREE YEARS ON



MAY 2018



Photo: HRRP Nepal

The Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) was established in December 2015 to take over supporting coordination of the post-earthquake housing reconstruction from the Nepal Shelter Cluster, as it returned to the pre-earthquake format as a standing cluster. The platform provides coordination support services for the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA), Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD) and Ministry of Federal Affairs and Local Development (MoFALD) Central Level Programme Implementation Units (CL-PIUs), other relevant government authorities, and Partner Organisations (POs). Phase 3 of the HRRP was approved by the Government of Nepal (GoN) at the beginning of March 2017 and will run until the end of February 2019.

The HRRP has 12 District Coordination Teams (DCTs) covering the 14 districts most affected by the 2015 Gorkha earthquake (1 team covers the three districts in the Kathmandu Valley). The DCTs are made up of a Coordinator, a Technical Coordinator, and an Information Management Officer. The DCTs are supported by a District Management Team (DMT) made up of a Coordinator, Technical Coordinator, and Information Manager. The DMT provides day to day guidance and support to the DCTs as well as targeted capacity building and has a roving presence across all 14 districts. The national team includes general coordination, technical coordination, and information management expertise and supports the link between national and district level.

The HRRP has three main areas of focus:

- **Improving Coverage and quality of Socio-Technical Assistance:** HRRP works closely with Partner Organisations (POs) and GON at National and district level to advocate for, and to facilitate improved coverage and quality of socio-technical assistance.
- **Research, Advocacy and Communication:** the HRRP acts as a common voice for PO's, facilitating advocacy from POs to the NRA/GON, and from the NRA/GON to POs, which focuses on addressing critical challenges/constraints in reconstruction in the districts. The HRRP also works to support communication and information flow between all reconstruction stakeholders and between national and district level.
- **Addressing gaps and duplication:** Despite the gaps in coverage of reconstruction, there are also duplication in activities. The HRRP works with partners to address these duplication, conducting mediation at national and district level for specific cases and supporting POs newly arrived or interested to expand to identify the most appropriate working areas based on need and gaps

Phase 3 of the HRRP was approved by the Government of Nepal (GoN) at the beginning of March 2017 and will run until the end of February 2019. The primary funders of the HRRP3 are DFID and CRS. The platform is led by CRS Nepal. The National Society for Earthquake Technology-Nepal (NSET), as an implementing partner, is leading on the technical coordination component of HRRP3. Other financial or in kind contributions have come from the Government of Nepal, SDC, Caritas Nepal, Plan International, Oxfam, WSP, ACTED, Christian Aid and Habitat for Humanity.

Get Involved!

- Visit the HRRP website - <http://hrrpnepal.org/>
- Subscribe to the HRRP mailing list – <http://www.hrrpnepal.org/subscribe>
- Follow the HRRP Flickr page (and share photos!) <https://www.flickr.com/photos/hrrp/with/32476019890/>
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Primary Funding:



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APRIL 2018

First Edition: April, 2018
Second Edition: May, 2018

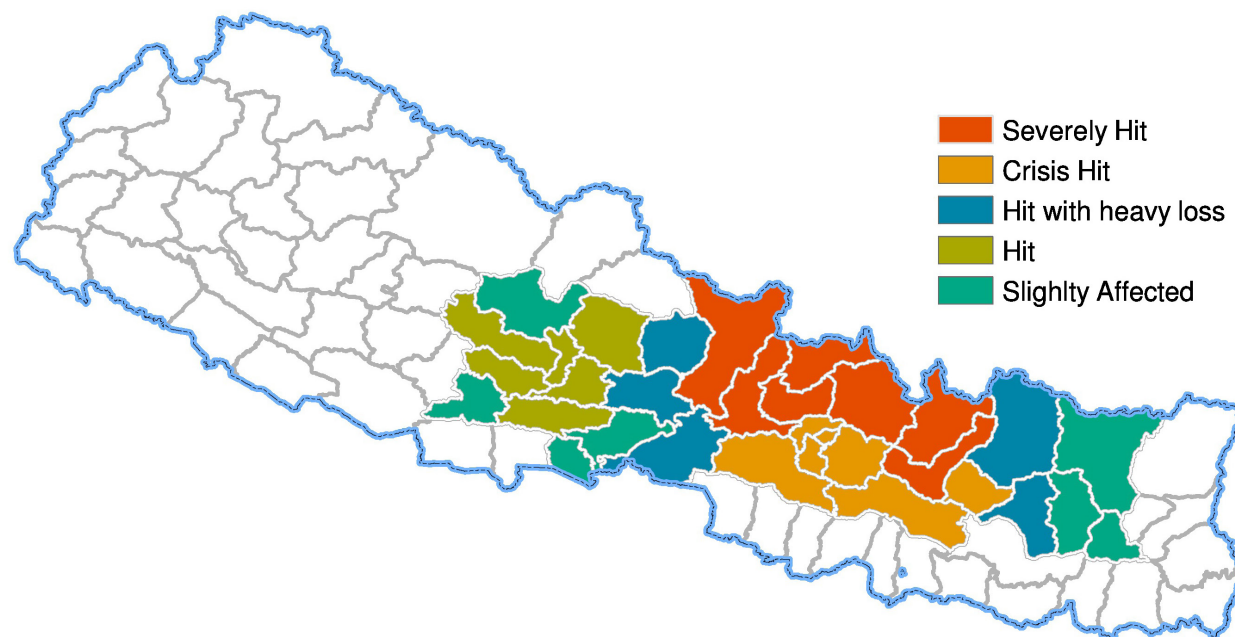


Introduction

The 25 April 2015 Gorkha Earthquake, and the hundreds of aftershocks that followed, including a M6.8 on 12 May 2015, caused loss of life and widespread damage to houses and infrastructure across 32 districts of Nepal. The Government of Nepal (GoN) categorised these districts as severely hit (7 districts), crisis hit (7 districts), hit with heavy losses (5 districts), hit (6 districts), and slightly affected (7 districts, at the time of the earthquake this was 6 districts but with the new governance structure Nawalparasi has been divided into two districts; Nawalpur and Parasi).

The Post Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA), published by the GoN in June 2016, identified housing as the most affected sector with the per capita average cost of earthquake damage ranging from 255,860 NPRs in Dolakha to 43,800 NPRs in Makwanpur, at an average of 130,000 NPRs per person across the 14 most affected districts. The PDNA also estimated that an additional 2.5% to 3.5% of the population, at least 700,000 people, would be pushed into poverty in the year following the quake as a result of the disaster.

Immediately after the April 2015 earthquake, emergency shelter assistance was provided to more than 1.2 million houses in the 14 most affected districts. The response then progressed to addressing longer-term temporary shelter needs with 699,157 households in the 14 most affected



districts receiving a 15,000 NPRs cash grant, or shelter materials of an equivalent value. The GoN, through the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA), began planning the owner-driven housing reconstruction programme in June 2015. The programme includes a housing reconstruction grant of 300,000 NPRs, provided by the GoN in three tranches linked to compliant construction; 50,000 NPRs upon signing a partnership agreement with

the GoN, a further 150,000 NPRs after constructing to plinth level, and a final 100,000 NPRs after building to ring beam level. A retrofitting grant of 100,000 NPRs is also available to households whose homes have been partially damaged. The NRA and the HRRP together have defined a core package of socio-technical assistance activities, to complement the GoN financial assistance.

As of March 2018, the Ministry of Federal Affairs and Local Development (MoFALD) Central Level Programme Implementation Unit (CLPIU) reports that of the 767,705 households eligible for the 300,000 NPRs GoN housing reconstruction grant, 91% have now signed the partnership agreement with the GoN, 89% have received the first tranche of money (50,000 NPRs), 34% have received the second tranche (150,00 NPRs), and 8% have received the third tranche (100,000 NPRs). Through these reconstruction grants, the GoN has so far directly distributed more than 760 million USD to people and families working to rebuild their homes. In addition, millions more has been invested by GoN and Partner Organisations in socio-technical assistance, helping people to rebuild better quality, safer homes.

This document presents a timeline of key points so far in the housing recovery over the past three years. Looking at the timeline it is clear that the limited time during the year when construction is possible - as a result of cold, snow, storms and rain - has significantly hampered and slowed people's recovery. However, this should only further emphasise the enormous efforts made by people at all levels, but most of all in those earthquake affected communities, that have been required to reach the point where we are now.

There are many lessons from the recovery process so far which demand reflection; we must learn from the efforts of the last three years and carry this forward in the years ahead to the completion of the housing reconstruction.



Photo: People in Need

Key principles for reconstruction as identified in the PDNA:

- Reconstruction should empower communities to take control of their recover facilitated through the Owner Driven Reconstruction (ODR) approach.
- Reconstruction should apply “integrated safer settlement” principles where appropriate, involving the principles of holistic habitat development with an emphasis on basic services and community infrastructure.
- Reconstruction should become a vehicle for building long-term community resilience.
- Reconstruction should strengthen the local economy through processes supportive of the poor, marginalised and informal sector. It should provide an opportunity for the poor to upgrade their overall living and eqnomic conditions.
- Reconstruction should ensure sustainable and environmentally conscious processes that keep in mind issues such as climate change, natural resource management, and scientific riskassessments.
- Reconstruction should be equitable and inclusive, with equal rights to land and property accorded to women.
- Reconstruction should be initiated through targeted strategies that address the specific needs of the diverse communities and settlements affected by the earthquakes.

25 April 2015

M7.6 earthquake, 11:56 NST
epicentre **Gorkha**
8,790 people died
22,300 people injured



Photo: Shelter Cluster, Nepal

Emergency shelter support provided to **1.2 million+ households**, this included tarpaulins, blankets and bedding. In the first few weeks of response, biggest providers of emergency food and shelter support were local businesses, CSOs, and communities themselves – demonstrating a high level of solidarity and local strength in response.

Initial Rapid Damage Assessment conducted by the Government of Nepal, **Red Card** system launched to identify earthquake beneficiaries



Shelter Cluster

Shelter Cluster Nepal launches **Technical Working Group (TWG)** on Technical Assistance and Training for Recovery

MAY

15 Partner Organisations reporting emergency shelter support (shelter cluster 4w)

12 May

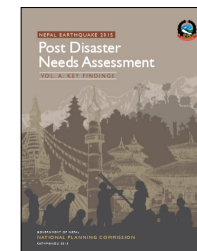
Biggest **aftershock**, **M7.3**, 12:50 NST
epicentre **Dolakha**
218 died
2500+ injured

May 2015



Photo: Shelter Cluster, Nepal

25 June
Post Disaster Needs Assessment (**PDNA**) launched

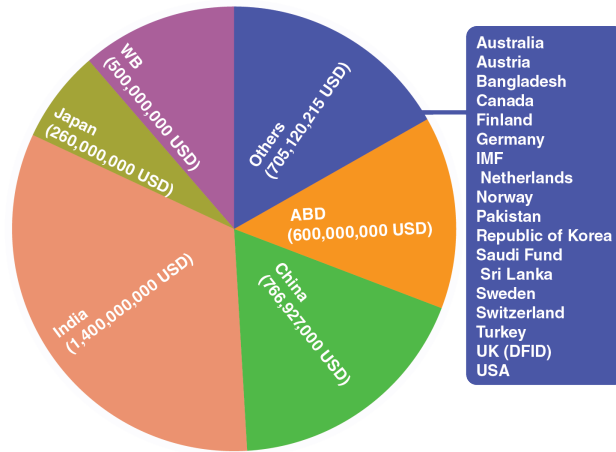


JUNE

Temporary shelter support starts.
GoN / POs provide cash grant of **15,000 NPRs** or material equivalent to **650,000+ households**.



PO



4.4 billion USD (two thirds of total appeal) committed by international donors to support recovery and reconstruction at donor conference.

August 2015

13 August

Cabinet establishes **National Reconstruction Authority (NRA)**, Dr. Govinda Raj Pokharel appointed CEO

31 August

NRA loses legal status

September 2015

16 September 2015

Constitution promulgated



1,430 masons trained by Partner Organisations (POs) and GoN (HRRP 4W)

JULY

June – September Monsoon season, generally less construction work takes place

July 2015



Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey (2100+ Respondents)

74%

Do not feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Do not have the information they need to access reconstruction support

67%

19 August

Flowminder reports that, with the exception of Rasuwa, all of the 14 of most affected districts, have experienced an inflow of people since the earthquake



Shelter Cluster

September 2015 – March 2016, unrest in the Terai

POs report 200 million USD in place for **housing recovery and reconstruction**. Shelter Cluster estimates indicate this would be enough to cover the delivery of the **minimum socio-technical assistance package** to all affected households in the **32 districts**.



Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project
Periodic Household Survey (2100+ Respondents)

72%

Do not feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Do not have the information they need to access reconstruction support

51%

10 September

Shelter Cluster Recovery and Reconstruction Working Group (RRWG) launched

WET

Minimal construction process during Monsoon (June - September)

October 2015

DUDBC Design Catalogue Vol. 1 published. The catalogue states “It is not mandatory for households to select a design from this catalogue, and they are free to prepare house designs outside of the catalogue but these designs must comply with the National Building Code”.

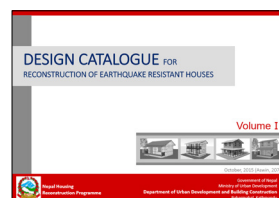


Photo: Chetraj Ojha, DLPIU

25 December
Mr. Sushil Gyawali appointed as CEO

21 December
Reconstruction Act 2072 issued
and NRA's **Policy Act** formed

OCTOBER

NOVEMBER

DECEMBER

October 2015 – March 2016: Winterisation support of 10,000 NPRs in cash or in-kind support provided based on Shelter Cluster guidance.

September 2015 – March 2016, unrest in the Terai and blockade at the borders



Photos: Shelter Cluster, Nepal

Phase 1 of Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (**HRRP**) **launched**, led by IOM and UN Habitat, taking over responsibility for supporting the coordination of the housing recovery and reconstruction efforts from the Nepal Earthquake Shelter Cluster.



115 Partner Organisations reporting emergency shelter support (shelter cluster 4w)

PO



Shelter Cluster

31 December
The Nepal Shelter Cluster reverts to pre-earthquake form as a standing cluster focusing on preparedness and contingency planning

Construction challenges during Winter (November - February)

COLD

15 January
CBS Detail Damage Assessment starts



Photo: HRRP Nepal

March 2016

13 March 2016
A pilot enrolment held in Singati, Dolakha, for households from Lamidada and Laduk VDCs.

31 March
Cabinet approved NRA NGO Mobilisation Guidelines launched.

15 January - 20 June: Detailed Damage Assessment conducted by the Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS), to determine eligibility for GoN housing reconstruction grant in 11 of the most affected districts (not including three Kathmandu Valley districts). 762,106 households surveyed using a census model in which each household is visited and assessed by a trained enumerator.

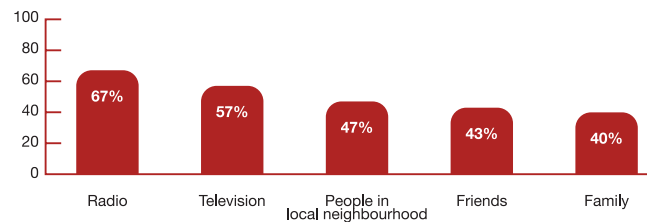
JANUARY

FEBRUARY

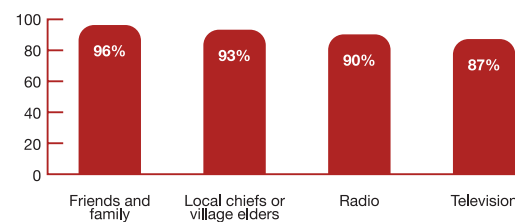
MARCH

September 2015 – March 2016, unrest in the Terai and blockade at the borders

BBC Media Action research



Most reported source of information



Most trusted source of information



Photo: HRRP Nepal

62 Partner Organisations supporting housing reconstruction (HRRP 4w)

PO

April 2016

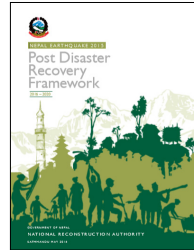
20,160 masons trained by POs (HRRP 4W)

Mid-April
NRA begins signing
reconstruction grant
agreements in 10 districts
outside Kathmandu Valley



May 2016

Post Disaster Recovery Framework (PDRF) launched



June 2016

GoN deploys **2,500+ engineers, sub-engineers, and assistant sub-engineers** supporting housing reconstruction in 14 worst affected districts.



Photo: DLPIU Gorkha

APRIL

MAY

JUNE



Photo: CRS Nepal

24 May

450+ aftershocks reported with magnitudes equal to or above M4 since April 25th 2015 (51 equal to or above M5, 5 above M6). 20,000+ aftershocks of less than M4 reported.

Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
(2100+ Respondents)



82%

Do not feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Do not know how to access reconstruction support

62%

68 Partner Organisations supporting housing reconstruction (HRRP 4W)

PO

July 2016

7th NRA Steering Committee meeting agrees to increase the GoN housing reconstruction grant from 200,000 NPRs to 300,000 NPRs.



August 2016

Procedures for handling of grievances related to reconstruction published by NRA



Photos: CRS Nepal

September 2016

29,340 masons trained by POs and GoN (HRRP 4W)



JULY

AUGUST

SEPTEMBER

11 July - 15 September: The Detailed Damage Assessment, conducted by the Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS), to determine eligibility for the GoN housing reconstruction grant is carried out in three Kathmandu Valley districts. Almost 114,414 households are surveyed under a system in which households certified by the local village and municipal authorities as earthquake-affected are assessed.

Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project



Periodic Household Survey
(2100+ Respondents)

74%

Do not feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Do not have the information they need to access reconstruction support

67%



Phase 2 of the HRRP launched, led by IOM

WET

Minimal construction process during Monsoon (June - September)

December 2016

19 December

Participation Agreements signed by **475,000+** households in **11 districts**, almost **450,000** received **first tranche** of the reconstruction grant. (GoN Reports)

25 December

First phase of **geo-hazard risk assessment** begins. NRA teams deployed.

29 December

Grant Disbursement Procedures for Private Houses Destroyed by the Earthquakes approved by Cabinet

November 2016

Inspection guidelines and associated **Inspection Forms** published by NRA.



October 2016

Community Reconstruction Committees Directive published by NRA

OCTOBER

NOVEMBER

DECEMBER



Photo: HRRP Nepal



25 November

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage (HRRP 4W)

9

VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA

296



Photo: Baliyo Ghar, NSET

Construction challenges during Winter (November - February)

COLD

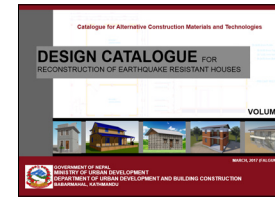
March 2017

January 2017

10 January 2017

Dr. Govind Raj Pokharel appointed NRA CEO

Refinancing Procedures for Reconstruction of Private Houses published by NRA



DUDBC Design Catalogue Volume 2

published, including designs for alternative technologies such as confined hollow concrete block masonry, hollow concrete block masonry, compressed stabilised earth block masonry, bamboo and stone masonry hybrid structures, and timber structures.

Inspection Forms (first and second inspection) published for dry stone masonry, and houses constructed using sun-dried bricks.

21 November 2016 – 14 April 2017: Detailed damage assessment, conducted by Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS) to determine eligibility for GoN housing reconstruction grant, carried out in 18 'moderately affected' districts. 176,428 households surveyed with system in which local village and municipal authorities certify households as earthquake affected.

JANUARY

FEBRUARY

MARCH

25 January

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage (HRRP 4W)

9

VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA

171

February 2017

Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey (2100+ Respondents)

55%

Do not feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Now have the information they need to access reconstruction support

58%

PO

81 Partner Organisations supporting housing reconstruction (HRRP 4w)



Phase 3 of the HRRP launched, led by CRS

May 2017

Partnership Agreements process begins in **18 moderately affected districts** with households eligible for reconstruction grant

April 2017



43,310 masons trained by POs and GoN (HRRP 4W)

7 May

Grant Disbursement Procedures for Private Houses Destroyed by the Earthquakes revised to reflect **increase in grant** (from 200,000 NPRs to 300,000 NPRs) and **repair and retrofitting grant** (100,000 NPRs)

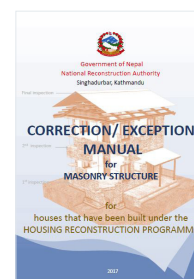
14 May

First phase of local elections. The ToR set out for Locally Elected Bodies.



15 May

Corrections and Exceptions Manual published by NRA.



June 2017

23 June

Criteria for purchasing habitable lands for earthquake victims published by MoFALD CLPIU.

28 June

Second phase of local elections.

27 'District Support Engineers' deployed across 14 districts by NRA, with support from UNDP, based in the MoUD DL-PIU offices, provide guidance and back up for field engineers.

NRA toll-free number launched.

16600172000 (NTC), 9801572111 (NCELL)

Procedures for interest-free loans to earthquake victims based on collective guarantee published by NRA

APRIL

MAY

JUNE

Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
(2100+ Respondents)



53%

Feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Have the information they need to access reconstruction support

75%

25 April

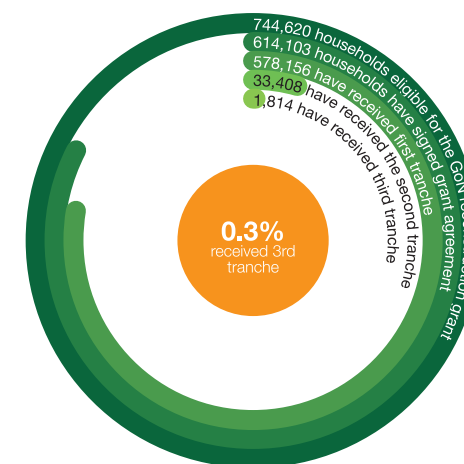
Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage
(HRRP 4W)

25

VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA

149



Source: MoFALD
June 2017

July 2017

Deadlines set by NRA for Disbursement of Housing Reconstruction Grant.

Grant agreement signing: November 16, 2017

First tranche: January 13, 2018

Second tranche: April 13, 2018

Third tranche: July 15, 2018



Photo: People in Need

August 2017

Relocation and Rehabilitation of Hazard-prone Settlements procedures published by NRA

Flooding. 12 districts heavily affected.

9,850 houses destroyed
301,500 families affected
44,700 families temporarily displaced
131 people killed
32 people missing
30 people injured

10 August – 16 September 2017: resurvey and verification conducted to address grievances with detailed damage assessment

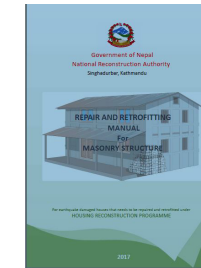
September 2017



51,270 masons trained by POs and GoN (HRRP 4W)



18 September
Third phase of local elections.



25 September
Repair and Retrofitting Manual for Masonry and RCC Structures and Hybrid Structures published by NRA

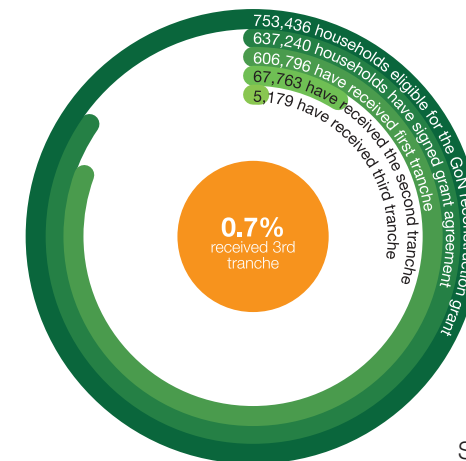
JULY

AUGUST

SEPTEMBER



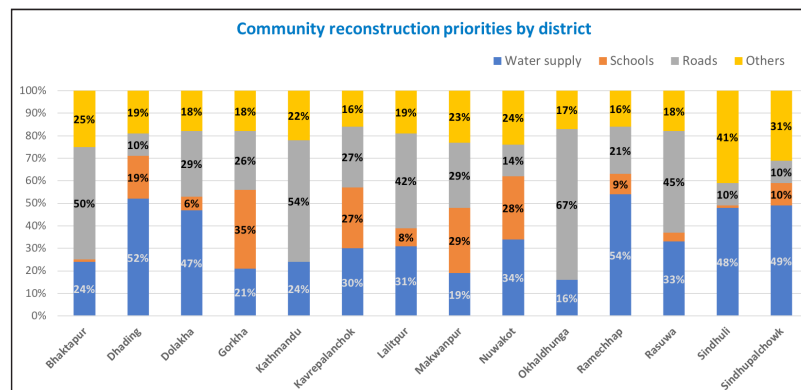
Photos: onlinekhabar.com



Source: MoFALD
September 2017

WET

Minimal construction process during Monsoon (June - September)



December 2017 Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project report. **Water supply remains an issue in 14 districts** (see graph). 37% of respondents say water supply is the biggest community reconstruction need followed by roads (31%) and schools (13%).

The report recommends continued restoration of access to necessary water supply for affected communities.

December 2017

450+ engineers, sub-engineers, and assistant sub-engineers deployed by the GoN to support housing reconstruction in the **18 moderately affected districts**.

Flood Post Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA) launched

October 2017

23 October

Mr. Yuburaj Bhusal appointed NRA CEO

7 December
Second phase of federal and provincial elections.



26 November
First phase of federal and provincial elections.



31 December
Local Governance and Community Development Programme (LGCDP) closes.
5,000+ social mobilisers supporting reconstruction no longer employed under the local authorities

OCTOBER

NOVEMBER

DECEMBER

Average house construction cost is 675,000 NPRs (approx. USD 6,750).

Almost 60% of respondents are or are planning to build using stone masonry with an average cost of 550,000 NPRs (approx. USD 5,500).

56% have taken loans (or are planning to) to reconstruct their home, at an average interest rate of 23% p.a. (HRRP report on the cost of construction)

The Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project
Periodic Household Survey (2100+ Respondents)

50%

Feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Have the information they need to access reconstruction support

76%

25 October

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage (HRRP 4W)

26

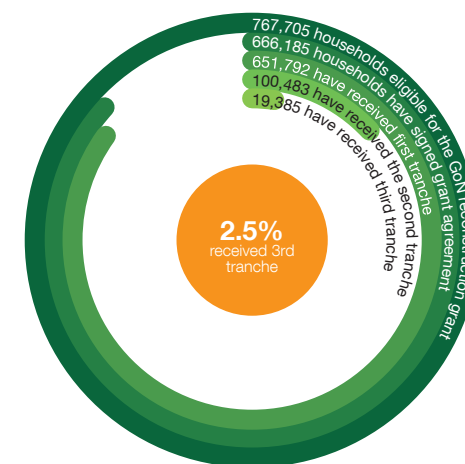
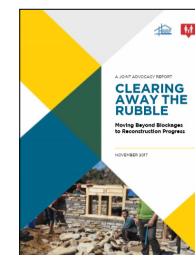
VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA

134



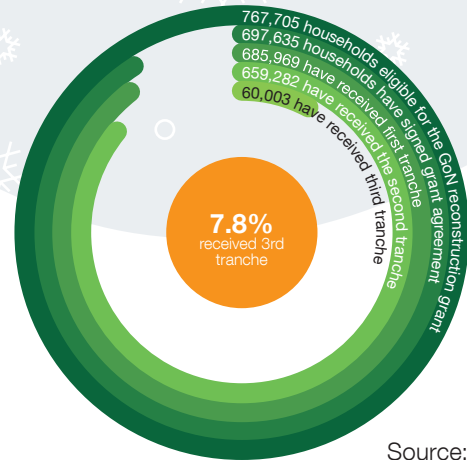
21 November
Clearing Away the Rubble: Moving Beyond Blockages to Reconstruction Progress launched (HRRP and Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project)



Source: MoFALD
December 2017

Construction challenges during Winter (November - February)

COLD.

Source: MoFALD
March 2018

9 February

Deadlines extended by NRA.
Second tranche disbursement by
13 April 2018

21 February
Project Monitoring
Information System
launched by NRA

28 February
NRA toll-free number
responded to **8,691** calls.

March 2018

54,179 masons trained by
POs and GoN, (HRRP 4W)



April 2018

3 April

Deadlines extended by NRA.
Second tranche disbursement by
16 July 2018

3 April

NRA restructured during 12th
Steering Committee meeting;
Central and District Level Project
Implementation Units now under
NRA.

JANUARY

FEBRUARY

MARCH

APRIL



Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage
(HRRP 4W)

27 VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA **124**

25 February

9 March

Women in Reconstruction Event.

Continued gaps in effectively engaging
and supporting women in housing
reconstruction highlighted.

15 March

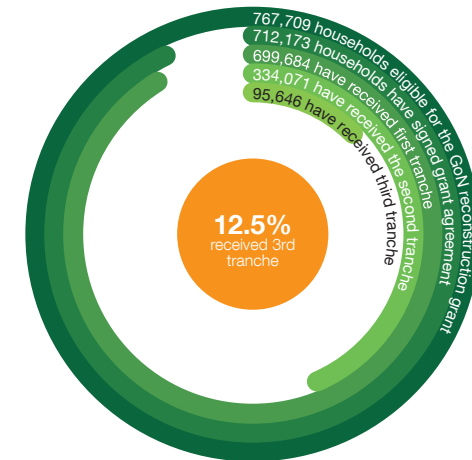
Temporary Shelter Status: 90%+ of
respondents living in temporary shelter
have not modified or improved their
shelter since it was built

Women in Reconstruction: almost
50% women respondents have signed
the Partnership Agreement with
government in their own name.

**Community Reconstruction
Committees (CRCs):** 50%+ of
CRCs not receiving any support from
reconstruction actors.
(HRRP surveys and research)

PO

102 Partner Organisations
supporting housing recovery
(HRRP 4W)

Source: MoFALD
April 2018

Where to next?

As the housing recovery and reconstruction moves into its fourth year, many questions still remain: what direction will the remainder of the reconstruction take? What are the indicators of a successful housing reconstruction? Can the housing reconstruction be classed a success if households build a technically compliant house that doesn't meet the inhabitants' living requirements? Can success only be claimed

if all reconstructed houses meet both technical compliance and lifestyle requirements?

The next building season, roughly September 2018 to April 2019, is likely to be the busiest so far, but is also likely to have the least support to date from Partner Organisations (POs) as PO presence scales down dramatically. In this context how can (or should) reconstruction actors better support households, field staff, and local officials with the housing reconstruction? What has been learnt from the three building seasons so far?

Coverage and quality of socio-technical assistance: coverage of socio-technical assistance (STA) has been limited throughout the recovery so far and there are challenges with the quality and consistency of information shared. As the presence of Partner Organisations (POs), and support for STA, looks set to reduce ahead of the next building season, how can we ensure people receive the STA they need as reconstruction speeds up?

Water supply: The Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project community perception surveys have consistently shown that water supplies have been impacted by the earthquakes and this in turn is creating challenges for the reconstruction. Further research and investigation is required to understand the extent of water supply challenges and to develop suitable options to address them.

Additional support for vulnerable and marginalised: the detailed damage assessments show that 324 VDCs have at least 30% female headed households, and at least 30% of the population is illiterate. There are more than 50 languages spoken across the 32 earthquake affected districts. Given the complex processes and technical requirements that are involved in the reconstruction process, and the need to fill in forms at every step, many households need additional socio-technical assistance to complete their reconstruction successfully.



Photo: HRRP Nepal

Tranche deadlines: as of 15 March, 34% of households eligible for the GoN housing reconstruction grant have received the second tranche. This is a significant achievement but with the deadline for the disbursement of the second tranche coming on 13 April it remains to be seen how this impacts the 66% of households yet to reach this stage. The deadlines may have motivated households to start building, but they also seem to have prompted a trend of constructing small, single-room buildings just to access the grant.

Support for field staff, CRCs, and local officials: these groups are the primary sources of support for households and are responsible for key elements of the housing reconstruction process. The lack of a standard understanding of the reconstruction process persists however and this continues to create confusion at household level. A continuous system of orientation and mentoring for these key groups would greatly benefit the reconstruction process.

Non-compliant construction and application of corrections: where construction has progressed without technical assistance (especially in the 18 moderately affected districts) buildings that do not comply with the technical requirements are prevalent. Applying the corrections needed to make a structure compliant requires significant technical assistance. Technical field staff need further orientation on the Corrections and Exceptions Manual to be able to apply it.



Photo: DFID

Finance and debt: the HRRP Cost of Construction report from October 2017 found that 56% of households interviewed had taken, or were planning to take, a loan to finance the reconstruction of their home, often at extremely high interest rates. The average loan amount was around 50% of the total construction costs. If 400,000 of the 767,705 households eligible for the GoN housing reconstruction grant take a loan of USD 3,250, that creates a cumulative debt of 1.3 billion USD. Is this going to lead to a potential debt crisis?

Retrofitting: to date, 24,991 households have been identified as eligible for the GoN repair and

retrofitting grant of 100,000 NPRs. Many houses that were categorised as eligible for the full GoN housing reconstruction grant could potentially be retrofitted instead, saving households thousands of dollars, and contributing to preserving vernacular architecture and housing that meets living requirements. However, in many areas households are being informed that they must demolish their damaged house to receive the second and / or third tranche of the housing reconstruction grant. Given the technical expertise required, is there a practicable and timely way to identify houses suitable for retrofitting and avoid unnecessary demolitions?

